

The Dance School Awards: Industry Award - Dance Teacher of the Year:

Dance Teacher of the Year Application / Nomination Questions.

Please find below 5 questions which we will need you to answer to proceed with your nomination.

Judges will consider:

- Quality and clarity of teaching practice
- Ability to motivate, inspire, and support students
- Awareness of different learning needs and pathways
- Commitment to student wellbeing and safe practice
- Evidence of professional integrity and reliability
- Ongoing professional development
- Positive impact within their school or community
- Commitment to inclusive and respectful teaching practice that supports a diverse range of students
- A clear case for why this teacher stands out this year

Email *

blommaertballetschool@gmail.com

Full Name *

sander blommaert

Email *

blommaertballetschool@gmail.com

Phone Number *

07793451054

Dance School Name *

Blommaert Ballet School

1. What makes you an exceptional teacher? *

I think I'm an exceptional teacher because of my unwavering commitment to the wellbeing and success of every child that I teach. I try to combine high academic and behavioural expectations with warmth, empathy and genuine care, creating an environment where pupils feel safe, valued and inspired to achieve their potential. My ability to build trusting relationships with pupils, parents and colleagues alongside my continual reflective approach to teaching, make me proud of the teacher that I am and the environment I create. I work consistently with professionalism, integrity and a deep understanding that every decision should be guided by what is in the best interest of the student.

2. How do you support and inspire your students? *

I support and inspire my students by creating a classroom environment in which every child feels safe, valued and capable of success. I take the time to understand each student as an individual, recognising their strengths, interests and areas for growth. Through consistent encouragement, clear guidance and high expectations, I help pupils develop confidence in their abilities and resilience when faced with challenges. I inspire students by making learning engaging and meaningful, encouraging curiosity, creativity and independent thinking. I celebrate effort as well as achievement, helping children understand that progress comes through perseverance and a positive attitude. My calm approachable manner enables students to ask questions, take risks in their learning and feel supported both academically and emotionally. By building strong relationships based on trust and respect, I motivate students to believe in themselves and strive for their personal best. My genuine care for my students wellbeing, combined with my passion for education, has a lasting impact that extends beyond the classroom and helps pupils grow into confident, responsible and motivated learners.

3. How do you continue to develop professionally? *

I have a strong commitment to continuous professional development by approaching teaching as a reflective and evolving practice. I regularly evaluate the impact of my teaching, seeking feedback and adapting my approach to ensure that every pupil receives the highest quality education that meets their learning needs.

I engage with current educational research and evidence-informed practice, using new ideas and strategies to enhance teaching and learning. Rather than solely relying on established methods, I continually look for opportunities to refine my practice, improve pupil outcomes and respond to the changing needs of my students.

I value collaboration with colleagues and I recognise that professional growth is strengthened through sharing expertise, observing best practice and contributing to a positive learning culture within my school. I am willing, open and interested to learn from others and I support development of my teachers on my team. At BBS our teachers are encouraged to observe another member of our teaching team at least once a month to support their own personal development.

I feel like my personal development extends far beyond pedagogy, I continually develop my communication with families, strengthen my leadership skills and reflect on how I can best support the wellbeing and personal development of every student.

Learning and teaching is a lifelong commitment to remaining adaptable, innovative and finding effectiveness for every student that comes into the classroom.

4. What impact have you had in the last year? *

Over the past year, I have tried to make a meaningful impact on both individual students and the wider dance community. Through my coaching and personalised approach, I have supported students in securing places at some of the world's leading vocational ballet schools, while also helping dancers achieve success at prestigious international competitions. My students have consistently demonstrated exceptional technical progress, increased confidence and a deeper understanding of artistry.

I have also continued expanded opportunities for aspiring dancers through my teaching at "Ballet On demand", making high quality ballet training accessible to students of all ages and abilities across the UK and internationally.

I have also continued monthly Ballet Giveaways where I collaborate with other industry professionals (teachers, dance shops, photographers to name a few) to create opportunities for students who might not normally have access to some of these incredible prizes.

5. Why should you be recognised now? *

I should be recognised because my impact extends far beyond the technical training of dancers. Over the past year, I have continued to demonstrate exceptional dedication to developing young people, helping student achieve remarkable success while fostering confidence, resilience and a life long love for dance and learning. My students consistently progress to leading vocational schools and excel in national and international competitions, reflecting not only the quality of my teaching but also my ability to inspire excellence in every individual.

What distinguishes me is my unwavering commitment to every students personal journey. I combine outstanding technical expertise with genuine care, ensuring that every dancer feels supported, challenged and valued regardless of their starting point. I think my teaching creates an environment where students develop not only as dancers but also as confident, disciplined and compassionate young people.

Recognising me now would mean so much to me, on a personal matter, I am going through a divorce from my husband which is a change in my personal life that I didn't see coming my way. I am so proud of myself that throughout this last year (as hard as it was for me personally and behind closed doors) I have continued to be the teacher that I am and to be honest, it is the passion for teaching and being there daily for my students that have gotten me through this pas year.

This content is neither created nor endorsed by Google.

Google Forms